

Leave Policy

Company: [Company Name] | Effective Date: [Insert Date] | Policy Owner: Human Resources / Finance

Purpose: This sample policy is designed for internal company use and should be reviewed and adapted to local laws, tax rules, employment requirements, and company-specific practices before adoption.

1. Purpose and Coverage

This policy summarizes common types of employee leave and the process for requesting time away from work. Actual entitlements may vary based on work location, employment classification, tenure, scheduled hours, and applicable law.

Where local law or a collective or employment agreement provides greater rights than this policy, the applicable legal or contractual requirement will control.

2. Vacation / Paid Time Off

Eligible employees may receive vacation or paid time off (PTO) according to the company's published accrual or grant schedule. Employees should request planned leave as early as possible and obtain manager approval before making non-refundable commitments.

- Approval depends on business coverage, staffing, deadlines, and fairness across the team.
- Employees should record PTO accurately in the company system.
- Carryover, caps, payout, and expiration rules are governed by the company plan and applicable law.

3. Sick and Safe Leave

Eligible employees may use sick leave for their own illness, injury, preventive care, medical appointments, or other legally protected reasons. Where required by law, leave may also be used to care for qualifying family members or for safe-leave purposes.

Employees should notify their manager as soon as practicable when they cannot work. Medical information should be shared only with HR or another authorized function when documentation is required.

4. Family, Medical, Parental, and Caregiver Leave

Employees may be eligible for job-protected or paid/unpaid family, medical, parental, bonding, pregnancy, caregiving, or related leave under applicable law or company benefit programs.

- Contact HR as early as possible for eligibility, documentation, benefit continuation, and return-to-work requirements.
- The company prohibits retaliation for requesting or using legally protected leave.

5. Bereavement Leave

Eligible employees may receive paid or unpaid bereavement leave following the death of a family member or other qualifying person. The amount of leave depends on company practice, relationship, travel needs, and applicable law. Managers should handle requests with sensitivity and reasonable flexibility.

6. Jury Duty, Voting, Military, and Civic Leave

The company provides leave for jury service, witness obligations, voting, military service, emergency response, and other civic duties as required by law. Employees should provide notice and documentation when reasonably available.

7. Unpaid Personal Leave

Employees who are not eligible for another leave may request unpaid personal leave. Approval is discretionary unless the leave is legally protected. HR and management will consider the reason, duration, business impact, performance history, and available alternatives.

8. Leave Request Process

- For planned leave, submit the request through the company system as early as practical.
- For unplanned leave, notify the manager using the team's normal call-off process.
- Provide requested documentation to HR, not broadly to coworkers or managers, when it contains medical or sensitive personal information.
- Keep the company informed of material changes to the expected leave or return date.

9. Benefits and Return to Work

Benefit continuation during leave depends on the type of leave, plan terms, and applicable law. Employees may be responsible for their normal share of benefit premiums.

When legally permitted, the company may request fitness-for-duty or return-to-work documentation for certain medical leaves or safety-sensitive roles. Reasonable accommodations will be considered through the company's interactive process where applicable.

10. Attendance and Abuse of Leave

Legitimate use of approved or legally protected leave will not be counted as an attendance violation. Fraudulent use, falsified documentation, or failure to follow reasonable notice procedures when no exception applies may result in corrective action.

Policy Administration: Questions about this policy should be directed to the policy owner. [Company Name] may revise this policy at any time, subject to applicable law and required notice.